University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

8,596: Real Estate Valuation

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Written examination, Analog, Individual work individual grade (60%, 60 mins.)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Teaching exercise, Digital, Group work individual grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
8,596,1.00 Real Estate Valuation -- English -- Fahrländer Stefan

Course information

Prerequisites

none

Learning objectives

The course provides knowledge of Swiss and international Real Estate Valuation Methods. After completing this course, the students have acquired the following skills:

- Students know the different approaches to real estate valuation and their varieties, and understand how to choose the preferred approach based on the property and valuation purpose.
- Students understand the market approach (comparative value method) as well as the basics of hedonic theory and its application in real estate valuation, and can conduct a valuation of a private property by using a professional valuation platform.
- Students understand the idea of the income approach in real estate valuation and know a variety of widely used models.
- Students can consistently build a variety of valuation models in an Excel spreadsheet and conduct valuations.
- Students can conduct, understand, and interpret a DCF valuation on a professional valuation platform.
- Students understand the importance of the consistency of valuation inputs.
- Students understand the influence of external factors, such as natural hazards or changes in regulation, on the value of a property.
- Students understand the difference between the valuation of an existing property and that of a real estate project and can conduct a valuation of a real estate project on a professional valuation platform.

Content

The course teaches the essential basics of real estate valuation and its core parameters, and their application in practical examples. These contents are divided into six modules that cover the following topics:

- Module 1: Introduction, Valuation and Reporting Standards. Overview of Valuation Approaches
- Module 2: Private Properties: Market Approach and Hedonic Models
- Module 3: Investment Properties: Income-Based Valuation Approaches
- Module 4: Income-Based Valuation Approaches and Core Parameters
- Module 5: Income-Based Valuation Approaches and Core Parameters (Cont.)
- Module 6: Valuation of Real Estate Projects and Special Properties

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

In addition to the weekly lectures, exercises sessions and independent studies take place as well. The exercise sessions are held during the lectures. As an important part of the independent studies, each student must complete several real estate valuations on his own Excel spreadsheet as well as by using a professional valuation platform.

Literature

1. **Course Materials:**
   Course materials include all lecture, exercise, and self-study materials.
2. **Mandatory literature:**
   None
3. **Additional literature (recommended):**

CEI et al. (2017). *Swiss Valuation Standard: Best Practice of Real Estate Valuation in Switzerland, 3rd edition, Zürich: vdf.*

Fahrländer, S. (2006):Semiparametric Construction of Spatial Generalized Hedonic Models for Private Properties, *Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics*, Vol. 2006 (4), p. 501-528.

Fahrländer, S. and S. Kloess (2024): *Immobilienökonomie: Lehrbuch in zwei Bänden, 2nd edition, St. Gallen: Schweizer Immobilienschätzer-Verband*.

IVSC – International Valuation Standards Council (2011): *Code of Ethical Principles for Professional Valuers.*

IVSC – International Valuation Standards Council (2013): *Technical Information Papers 1-4.*

IVCS – International Valuation Standards Council (2020): *International Valuation Standards* 400 and 410.

Additional information

None

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written examination
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written exam
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	60%
Duration	60 mins.

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

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Examination-aid rule
Closed Book

The use of aids is prohibited as a matter of principle, with the exception of pocket calculator models of the Texas Instruments TI-30 series and, in case of non-language exams, bilingual dictionaries without any handwritten notes. Any other aids that are admissible must be explicitly listed by faculty members in the paragraph entitled “Supplementary aids” of the course and examination fact sheet; this list is exhaustive.

Procuring any aids, as well as ensuring their working order, is the exclusive responsibility of students.

Supplementary aids

Calculator

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2. Examination sub part (2/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Teaching exercise
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Practical test
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Group work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Case study- individual or in groups of two - TBD

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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Content

All lecture material.

Literature

None.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).